

Sustainable Sutra — Exam Notes (LaTeX)

Prepared for B.Tech Revision

November 9, 2025

How to use these notes

- Each question is written in an exam-friendly style (approx. 7-mark answer).
- Key points are bolded and short paragraphs make it easy to memorise.
- Use the **Takeaway lines** for last-minute revision.

1. Q1: Meaning of “Sustain” and “Sustainability”

Meaning of “Sustain”

- “Sustain” means to **support, nourish, enrich, and keep growing**. It refers to actions that ensure continued life and well-being.
- Everyday essentials — *food, water, shelter, air, family and community* — are the resources that sustain life. Proper care and judicious use of these resources maintain social, economic and environmental harmony.
- **Exam line:** “To sustain is to maintain and enrich life continuously without depleting resources.”

Meaning of “Sustainability”

- Sustainability means: *meeting present needs without compromising future generations’ ability to meet their own needs*.
- It balances three pillars: **Economic growth, Social equity, and Environmental protection**.
- **Simple formula:** $Sustainability = Use\ today \rightarrow Preserve\ for\ tomorrow$.
- **Takeaway:** Sustainable choices ensure long-term well-being for people and planet.

2. Q2: Short note on UNESCO’s Model of Sustainability

Core idea

- UNESCO and many international frameworks present sustainability with **three pillars**: *Environment, Social, Economic*.
- When these three dimensions are in balance, development is considered sustainable.

Practical meaning and examples

- **Environment:** conserve biodiversity, control pollution, protect ecosystems.
- **Social:** equality, education, health, justice.
- **Economic:** jobs, growth, responsible use of resources.
- Example: A city that uses renewable energy (environment), provides social housing (social) and creates green jobs (economic) follows this model.

Limitations (concise exam points)

1. Focuses mainly on material and external development (infrastructure, GDP).
2. Lacks explicit emphasis on inner values: ethics, compassion, cultural practices.
3. Because of this omission, problems such as social inequality and environmental degradation may persist despite “development.”

3. Q3: Indic Model of Sustainable Development & Major Categories

Introduction

- The **Indic Model** draws on ancient Indian civilisational wisdom: it treats the world as a *family* (*Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*) and connects inner values with outer practice.
- Unlike the UNESCO triad, Indic Model explicitly includes **ethical, cultural and spiritual** norms, making sustainability holistic.

Why more effective?

- Indian civilisation preserved sustainability rituals (tree worship, water conservation, charity) across generations.
- By emphasising personal virtues (compassion, charity, hygiene), the Indic model works at the grassroots level and thereby supports larger societal balance.

Five major categories (overview)

1. Harmony with Biodiversity (Nature conservation)
2. Charity (Economic norms)
3. Compassion (Ethics)
4. Brotherhood (Social harmony)
5. Hygiene (Personal well-being)

4. Q4: Explain the five major categories (detailed, easy to remember)

1. Harmony with Biodiversity

- **Components:** Trees, Animals, Water (rivers/lakes), Earth (land/soil).
- **Key idea:** Respect nature like a living being — take only what you need (*gardener vs. woodcutter* analogy).
- **Scriptural support:** Tree planting, building tanks/ponds, and reverence for rivers appear across texts — showing that ecological conservation was a cultural duty.
- **Memory tip:** Think **T-A-W-E** = *Trees, Animals, Water, Earth*.
- **Exam sentence:** “Harmony with biodiversity means protecting trees, animals, water and land so natural systems can continue to support human life.”

2. Charity (Dāna) – Economic norms

- **Key idea:** Sharing wealth is both a moral duty and a means to reduce inequality.
- Historically, kings and citizens gave to the needy; festivals institutionalised giving.
- **Effect:** Charity smooths economic differences, promotes social cohesion and trains the giver to be humble.
- **Memory tip:** “Earn & Give” — the Indic route to stable society.

3. Compassion (Ethics)

- **Key idea:** Compassion (*Karuna*) extends to humans, animals and nature; it is the ethical base of sustainability.
- Ancient texts advise respect for every being and condemn cruelty.
- **Effect:** Compassion reduces exploitation and creates justice — essential for long-term social stability.
- **Memory tip:** Compassion = **Care for all**.

4. Brotherhood (Social Harmony)

- **Key idea:** *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* — the world is one family.
- Emphasises inclusivity, empathy and shared responsibility beyond narrow identities.
- **Effect:** Trust and cooperation increase; conflicts and hoarding decrease.
- **Memory tip:** Think "**World = Family**".

5. Hygiene (Personal Well-being)

- **Key idea:** Cleanliness of body, surroundings and public places is a civic duty linked to health and sustainability.
- Rules existed against polluting water bodies and public spaces; fines ensured compliance.
- **Effect:** Hygiene prevents disease, protects ecosystems and reflects inner discipline.
- **Memory tip:** Clean person → Clean society → Clean environment.

Quick comparison and final takeaway

- **UNESCO model:** Environment + Social + Economic (good for policy framing).
- **Indic model:** Biodiversity + Charity + Compassion + Brotherhood + Hygiene (adds moral and grassroots dimensions).
- **Final line for exam:** "True sustainability connects external development with internal values; the Indic model provides a holistic roadmap by combining ecology, economy, ethics and personal discipline."

Source: Dr. Shraddha M. Modi, "Indic Model of Sustainability Sutras" (lecture notes) — used here to structure exam-ready answers.